The street can win this saver for less than an app, and a loan marketplace can pay for the agent if 37 of 100 keep saving: we should pilot it.

Online is costly to keep

₹2,067

per saver still saving after a year.

The street wins him for less

₹240

a saver: ₹20,000 a month × 12 ÷ 1,000 sign-ups a year.

Savings alone do not pay

₹147

a saver a year from the fund: too little for his salary.

Products can pay for him

₹29,235

a year per 100 proven savers, plus ₹6,250 once from cards.

Retention decides

37 of 100

still saving after a year makes one agent's 5-year NPV positive.

✓ Our final thought: pilot it, small and on salary

One salaried agent for 12 months; it can cost ₹1,33,693–₹1,70,896 net. Stop if fewer than 78 of 100 still save at month 3 or 61 at month 6; scale only at 37+ at month 12.

NPV = today's value of income minus cost, discounted 20% a year. Bear case = 30–40 of 100 still saving after a year.

Everything after this page is the evidence; every assumption is in appendix A1.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_money_v2.csv, xs_breakeven_v2.csv, pilot_rules_v2.csv; online: story_unit.csv.

Online, winning a daily saver costs ₹499, and each one still saving a year later costs ₹2,067.

HOW AN APP WINS A DAILY SAVER, AND WHAT IT COSTS



₹2,067
for each saver still saving after a year

and he earns back only ₹188
over 5 years: the app
never recovers what it paid

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SAYS

Groww
₹796–1,374 a customer, with 83% coming free

Finance-app installs
₹100–300 each

Jar, Stable Money
₹249 a saver, only if half of sign-ups save

SBI's ₹250 daily SIP
lost 35.6% of FY26's new savers within the year

With every product we sell, an app's saver earns back ₹188 of the ₹499 it paid to win him.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: distributions.csv (online cost to win: TB-18..22, TB-37, TB-38, BM-04, BM-05, NG-043), story_unit.csv, xs_money_v2.csv; SBI daily SIP: NG-033.

A street agent can win him for less, keep him saving with a visit every 2–3 days, and earn more from him than he costs.

H1

Win him for less

₹240 a saver

his salary ÷ his sign-ups; his visits come from the same salary

online: ₹499

H2

Keep him saving with the visit

37+ of 100

still saving after a year: where one agent breaks even over 5 years

online: 24 of 100

H3

Earn more than he costs

₹463

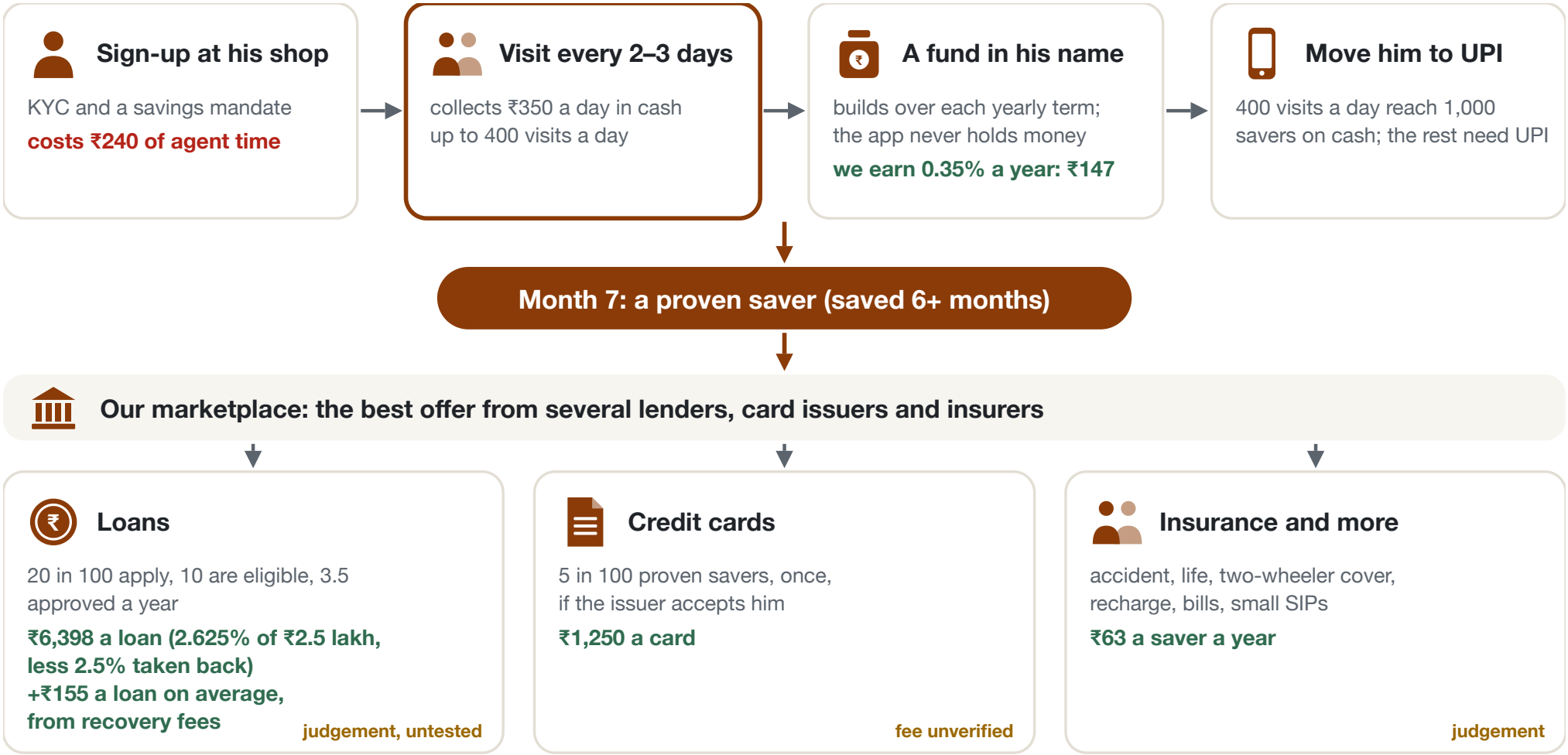
one customer's 5 years at 55 of 100 still saving, against his ₹240 cost

online: ₹188 back on ₹499

Each part can fail on its own. Pages 5–9 test them; page 14 is how the pilot checks them.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_money_v2.csv, xs_breakeven_v2.csv, story_unit.csv.

We sign him up at his shop, collect into a fund in his name, move him to UPI, and from month 7 offer loans, cards and insurance.



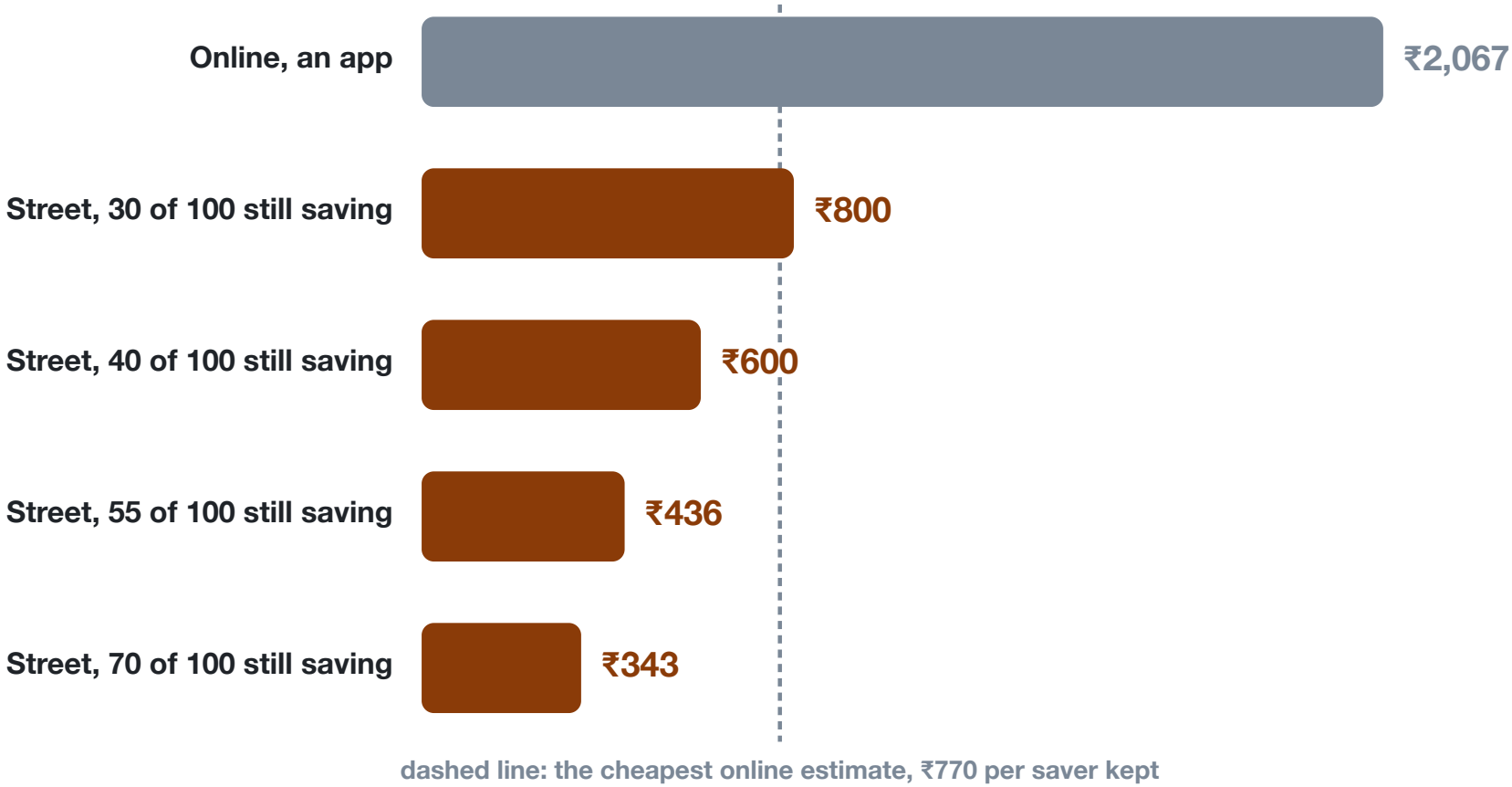
The NPV counts one salary for his whole book: that holds only if 39 of 100 move to UPI by year 5 (at 55 still saving; 58 at 70).
It assumes savers on UPI stay and earn as cash savers do; the pilot's UPI-only group tests this.

Every rupee we earn comes from a partner; the visit keeps him long enough to reach month 7.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_inputs_v2.csv, xs_years_v2.csv. The lender pays the fee: XL-01; every matching offer shown: XL-46; the issuer decides: REG-087.

The street wins him for ₹240, not ₹499.

WHAT EACH SAVER STILL SAVING AFTER A YEAR COSTS TO WIN

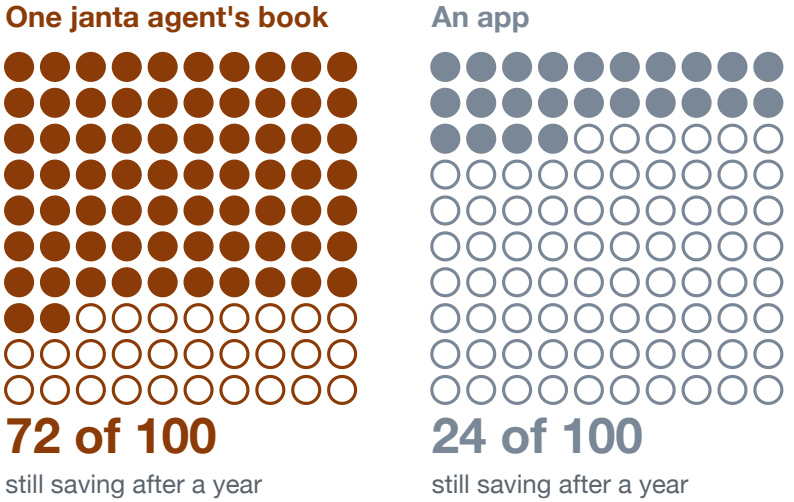


Even at 30 of 100 still saving, each saver kept costs ₹800, not ₹2,067; only against the cheapest online estimate is the bear case no cheaper.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: story_unit.csv, distributions.csv (online cost to win, low end).

He already saves daily, in cash, with an agent he trusts; one janta agent's churn implies about 72 of 100 still save a year later.

- **Saves ₹200–500 a day, in cash, with a janta agent**
- **9–10 in 10 have UPI, yet 90+ of every ₹100 is cash: “habit”**
- **Asks his agent about loans and insurance**
- **6–10 join and 6–10 leave a month on a book of 200–400**



This is one agent's account of his own long-standing book, not a group of new savers we have measured.

Agent interview, 15 Oct 2026 (IV-01, IV-03, IV-06 to IV-08, IV-12): 6–10 of 200–400 leave a month. Tables: story_unit.csv.

Savings alone do not pay the agent: the fund earns about ₹147 a saver a year.

ONE SAVER, ONE YEARLY TERM

₹350 a day × 20 days

₹7,000 into his fund a month

↓

it builds up, paid out at term end

₹42,000 held on average

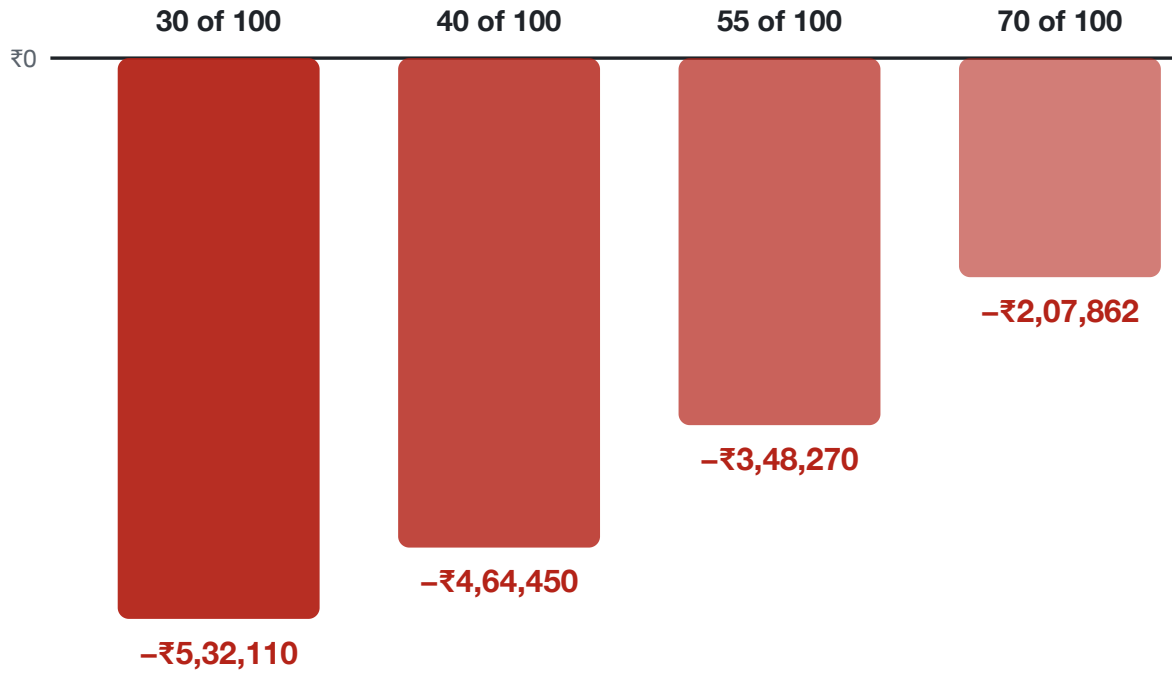
↓

× 0.35% a year fund commission

₹147 to us, a year

ONE AGENT'S 5-YEAR NPV ON SAVINGS ALONE

still saving after a year:

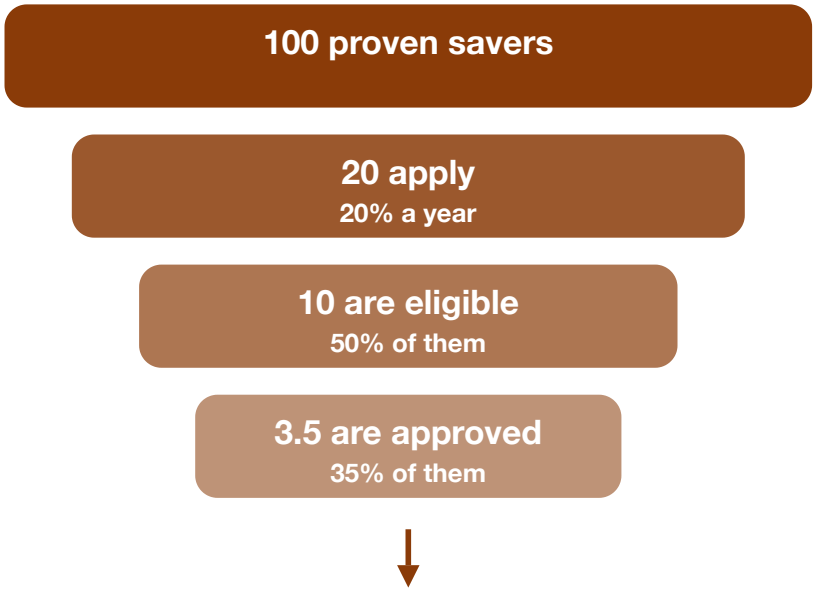


On savings alone, one agent's 5-year NPV is negative at every retention we test; he would need 88 of 100 still saving.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_npv_v2.csv, xs_breakeven_v2.csv. Fund commission: XB-04.

100 proven savers can bring ₹29,235 a year from the marketplace, plus ₹6,250 once from cards.

THE LOAN FUNNEL: 100 PROVEN SAVERS, ONE YEAR



apply, eligible and approved rates: our judgement, untested

RUPEES FROM THE SAME 100 PROVEN SAVERS

Loan origination fees, a year
3.5 loans × ₹6,398
₹22,395

Insurance and other products, a year
100 × ₹63 (judgement)
₹6,300

Recovery fees on bad loans, a year
small
₹541

Credit cards, once
if issuers accept him: most cards need income proof
₹6,250 once

The marketplace ₹29,235 a year + ₹6,250 once

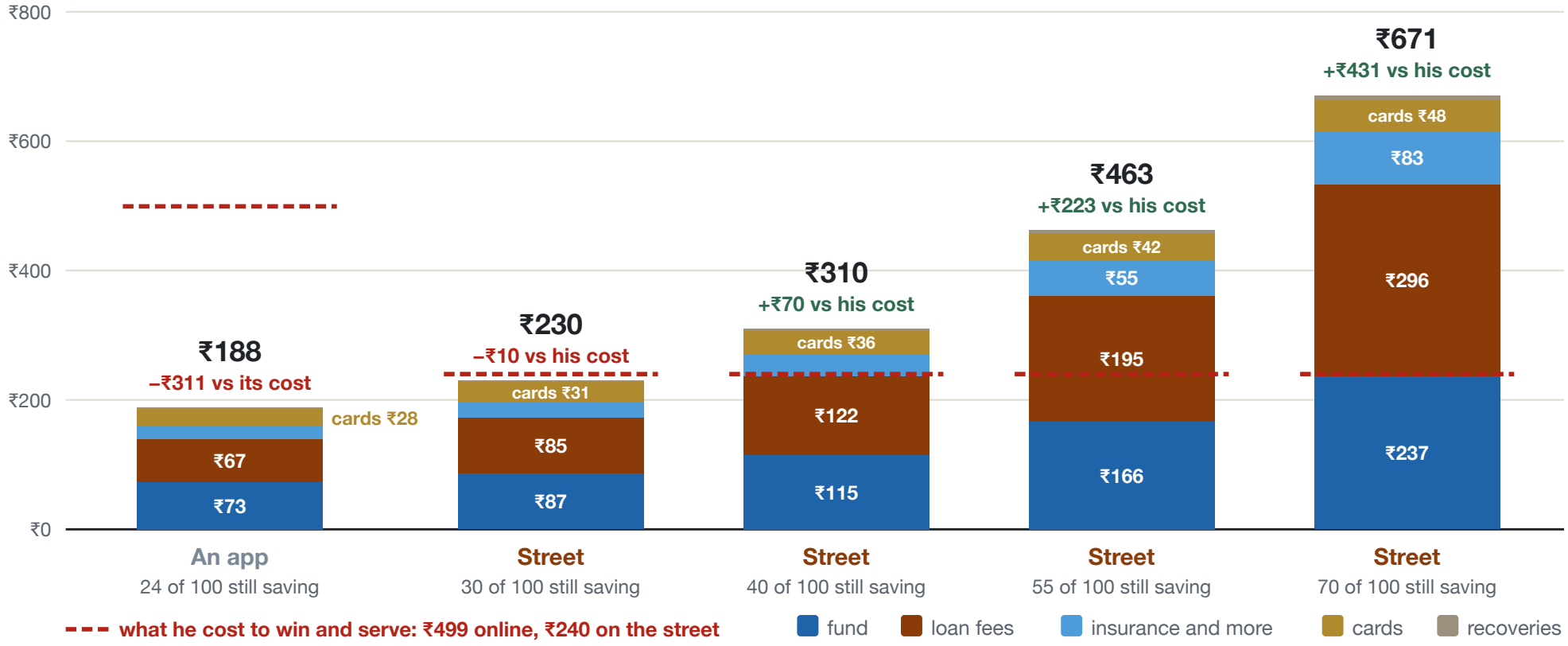
The fund on the same savers (page 7): ₹14,700 a year

Once his book is steady, cards bring one agent about ₹46,351 a year at 55 of 100, if issuers accept his savers.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_money_v2.csv, xs_years_v2.csv. Funnel: A2; fee: A3; cards: A4; insurance and more: A5.

At 55 of 100 still saving, one customer won can earn us about 2× what he costs to win and serve; an app's saver earns back under half of his.

WHAT ONE CUSTOMER WON CAN EARN US OVER HIS FIRST 5 YEARS, BY PRODUCT (DISCOUNTED)



Loan funnel and insurance take-up are our judgement; the card fee is unverified (A1).

Loan fees and the fund carry most of his value; at 30 of 100 still saving he earns back less than his ₹240.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_money_v2.csv (one sign-up's first 60 months, at 55 of 100 unless shown; street cost = salary per sign-up).

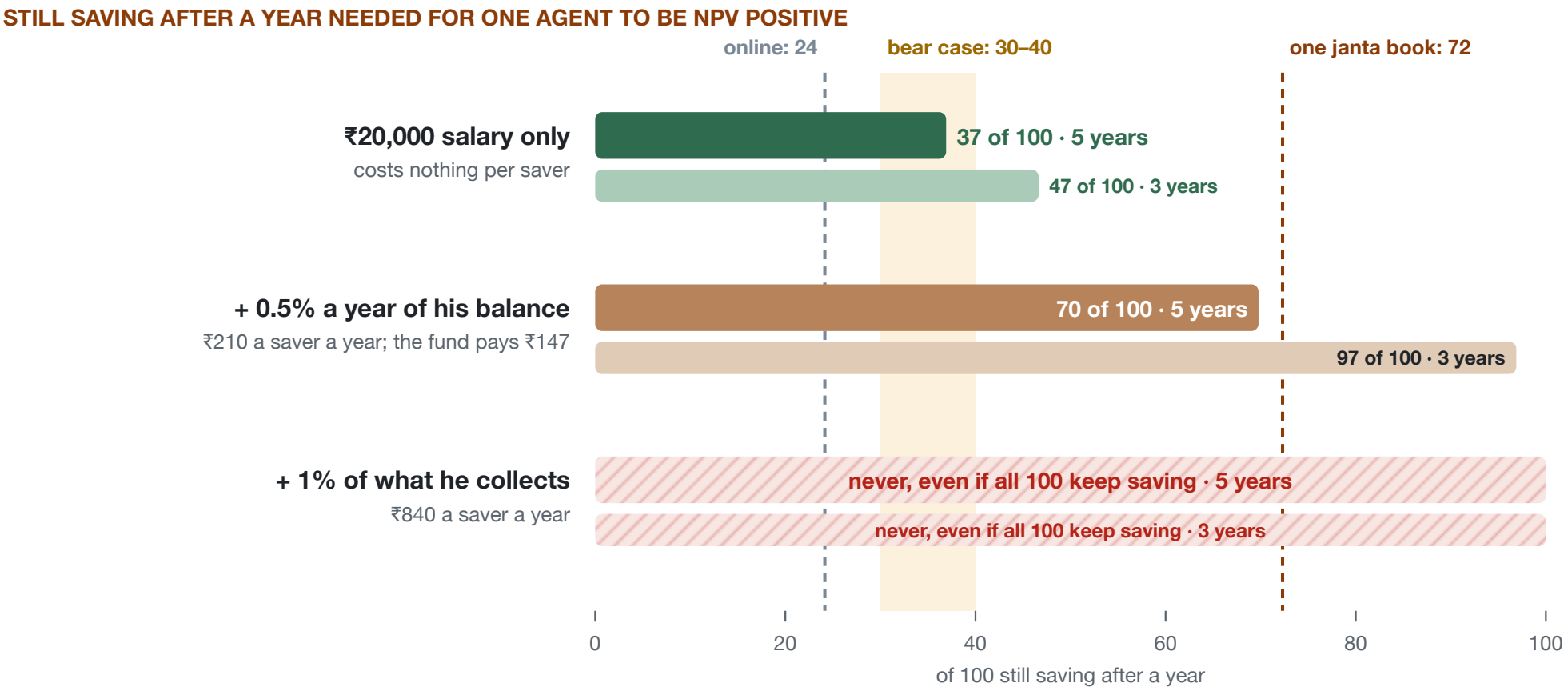
We win him about 20× cheaper, but Paytm earns more from each one.

	Paytm	Us, salaried street agent	Who is ahead
ROUND 1 **Win him**	up to ~₹5,000 a device (an upper bound)	**₹240 a saver**	✓ Us, about 20× cheaper
ROUND 2 **Keep him**	a box on the counter	**the visit; we need 37+ of 100 still saving**	? Open: the pilot decides
ROUND 3 **Earn from him**	₹1,080 a year in device rent, plus loan fees collected from the till	**₹439 a year all-in per proven saver, plus ₹62 once from cards**	✗ Paytm: over 2× a year

Paytm's loan fee pays for collecting from the shop's daily payout; ours is a one-off fee from the lender. Round 2 is what the pilot tests.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: story_paytm.csv (QM-06..22, XL-07, XB-08), xs_paytm_v2.csv. Detail: A7.

Salary is the only pay that works.

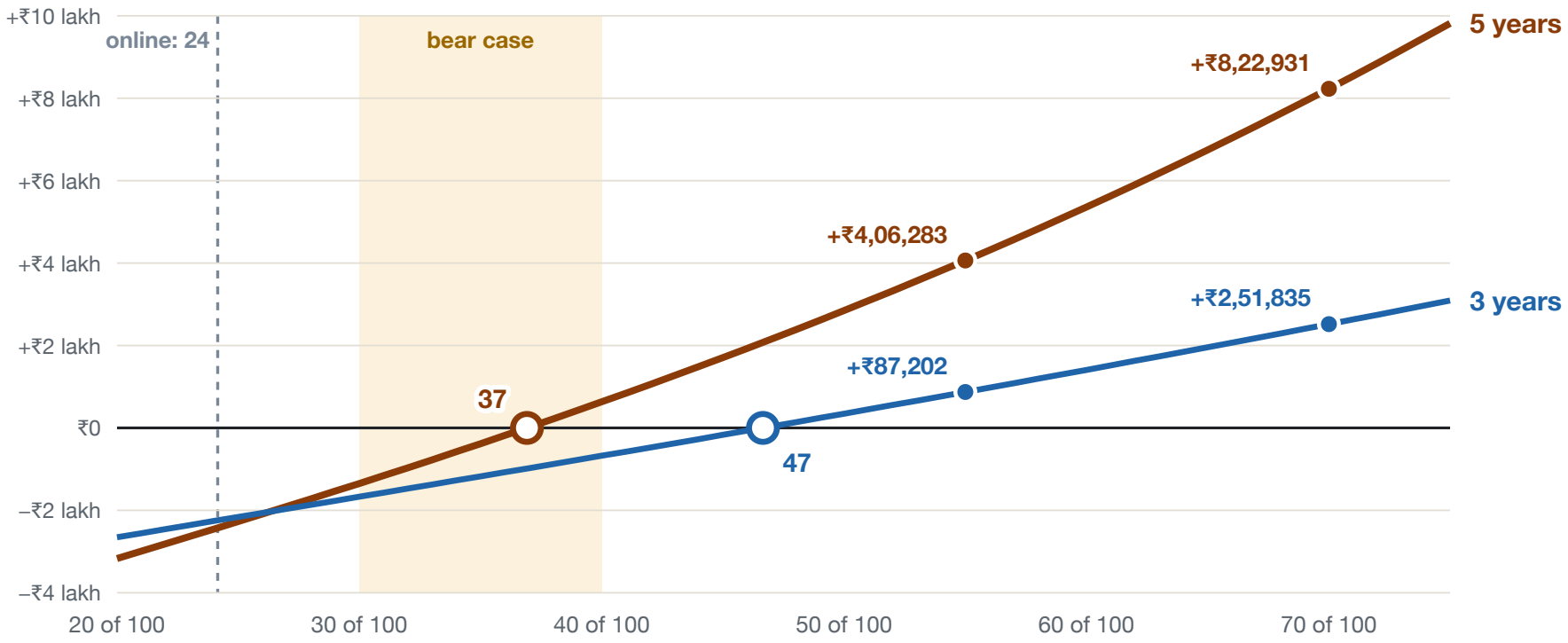


The fund pays us ₹147 a saver a year; 0.5% of his balance costs ₹210 and 1% of collections ₹840, so those pays lose money on every saver kept.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_breakeven_v2.csv, story_unit.csv.

On salary, one agent pays for himself over 5 years if 37 of 100 still save after a year.

ONE AGENT'S NPV ON SALARY ONLY, BY HOW MANY STILL SAVE AFTER A YEAR

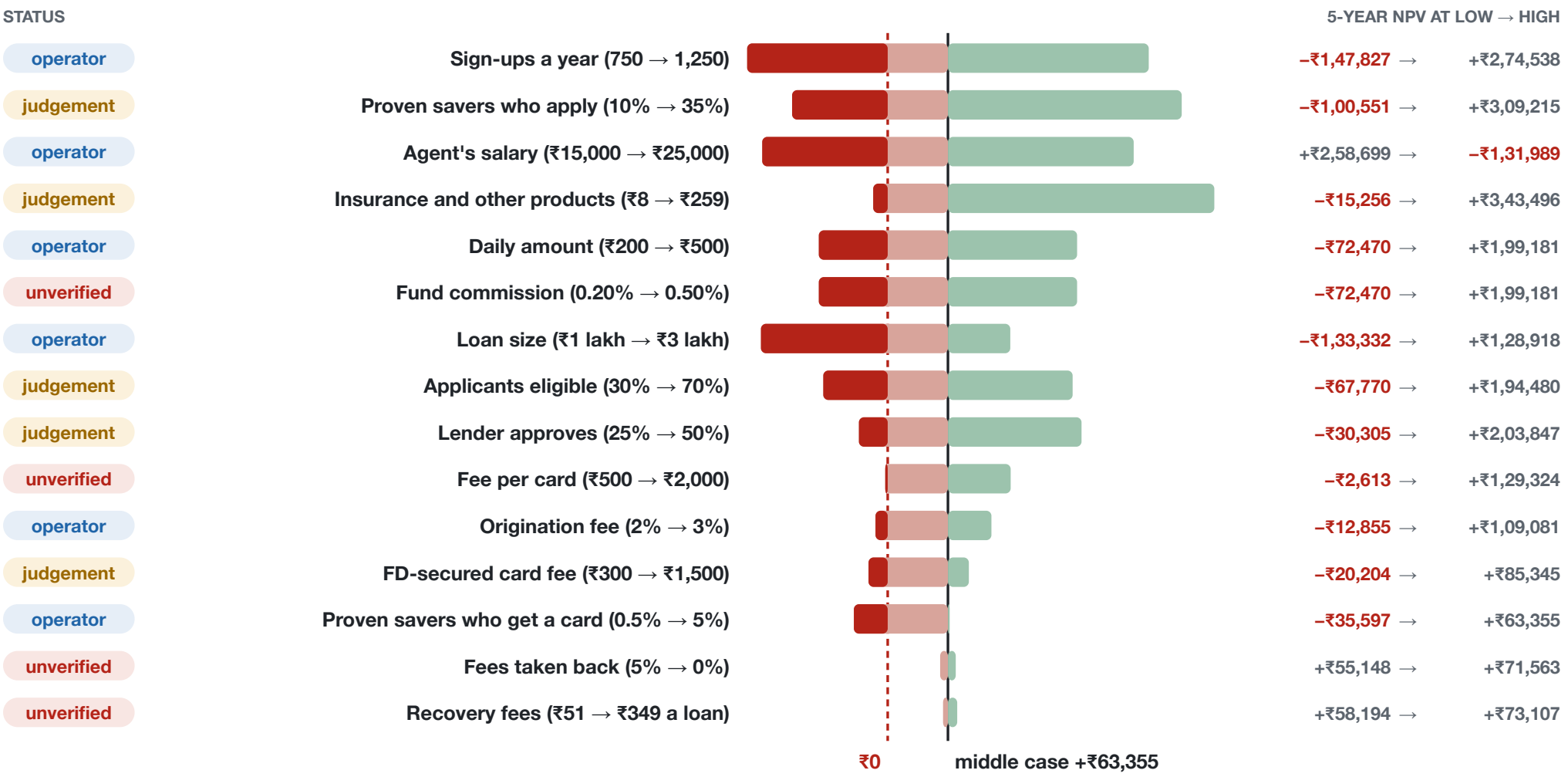


Over 3 years he needs 47 of 100, above the bear case; at 30 of 100 he loses ₹1,34,752 over 5 years.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_npv_curve_v2.csv, xs_npv_v2.csv, xs_breakeven_v2.csv.

At 40 of 100 still saving the margin is thin: 13 of 15 inputs, each alone at its bad end, turn the 5-year NPV negative.

ONE AGENT'S 5-YEAR NPV, SALARY ONLY, 40 OF 100 STILL SAVING: EACH INPUT MOVED ALONE



Sign-ups, the apply rate and his salary swing it most. At 55 of 100, no input alone turns it negative.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_oneway_v2.csv (also at 55 of 100), status from xs_inputs_v2.csv.

Pilot one salaried agent for a year; scale only if 37 of 100 still save at month 12.



Sign-ups

✓ go

83 a month (1,000 a year)

✕ stop

below 63 a month

Still saving

✓ go

78+ of 100 at month 3, 61+ at month 6

✕ stop

below 78 at month 3 or 61 at month 6

The marketplace

✓ go

by month 12: about 20 applications (20 in 100 proven savers a year), 3 loans and 19 cards

! rethink

at 1 loan or none

Visits and UPI

✓ go

at 55 of 100, year 2 needs 478 cash visits a day if none use UPI: 17+ of 100 must be on UPI

✕ stop

over 400 a day with few on UPI

Still saving after a year

✓ go

37+ of 100 (47+ for a 3-year payback)

✕ stop

below 37: do not scale

The month-3 line assumes a steady drop-off and reads only about 83 savers (month 1's sign-ups): read it as a warning, not a verdict.
The visits and UPI gate assumes savers on UPI stay and earn as cash savers do; the pilot's UPI-only group tests this.

THE PILOT YEAR, IN CASH

salary ₹2,40,000; his savers bring in ₹69,104–₹1,06,307

net cost ₹1,33,693–₹1,70,896

recovery fees (later) and support costs not counted

IF IT SCALES: 5-YEAR NPV PER AGENT, BY HOW MANY STILL SAVE

30 of 100	40 of 100	55 of 100	70 of 100
–₹1,34,752	+₹63,355	+₹4,06,283	+₹8,22,931

Run a UPI-only comparison group alongside, and ask two lenders and one card issuer to confirm the fee and who they would approve.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: pilot_rules_v2.csv, xs_years_v2.csv, xs_npv_v2.csv. Support costs: A10.

Every assumption, with its low, middle and high value, where it comes from, and how sure we are.

INPUT	LOW	MIDDLE	HIGH	PER	SOURCE IDS	STATUS	NOTE
Agent's salary	₹15,000	**₹20,000**	₹25,000	a month	operator; IV-13	operator	₹20,000 is yours; ₹15,000–25,000 is the janta agent's pay. Stress pays: + 0.5% of balance, + 1% of collections
Sign-ups per agent a year	750	**1,000**	1,250	a year	operator	operator	1,000 is yours; ±25% is our range
Still saving after a year	30 of 100	**55 of 100**	70 of 100		operator (30–70)	judgement	55 is ours: between the bear case (30–40) and one janta agent's book (72); same drop-off every month
Daily amount a saver puts in	₹200	**₹350**	₹500	a day	operator; IV-03	operator	₹350 is yours; ₹200–500 from the interview
Deposit days a month		**20**		days	none	judgement	240 deposit days a year; no source
Money held in his fund	₹3,500	**₹42,000**	₹80,500	per saver	derived	derived	Yearly terms: builds by ₹7,000 a month, paid out at each term's end; ₹42,000 on average
Fund commission a year, on the balance	0.2%	**0.35%**	0.5%	a year	XB-04	unverified	Debt-fund distributor commission (AMC and adviser blogs)
Months of saving before he is offered products		**6**		months	operator	operator	From month 7 he is a proven saver: loans, cards, insurance and more
Days between visits to a cash saver	2	**2.5**	3	days	operator	operator	Every 2–3 days
Cash visits one agent can make a day		**400**		a day	IV-01; the 3-year agent model	judgement	Top of a 200–400 janta book; 400 a day at every 2.5 days = 1,000 savers on cash
Proven savers who apply for a loan in a year	10%	**20%**	35%	a year	XL-42, LS-06, XL-04	judgement	Kissht 17.5% ever borrowed; Brazil 20% in year one; founder 35%
Applicants who can carry a ₹2.5 lakh EMI	30%	**50%**	70%		XB-09, IV-04, XL-34	judgement	₹10,073 EMI needs ₹20,145+ income at the 50% rule; customers earn ₹20–40k
Eligible applicants a lender approves	25%	**35%**	50%		XL-41; founder	judgement	Several lenders; one lender gave the founder 25%; Kissht approves 11% new, 74% repeat
Loans per 100 proven savers a year	0.75	**3.5**	12.25	a year	derived	derived	Apply × eligible × approved
Loan size	₹1,00,000	**₹2,50,000**	₹3,00,000		operator; XB-08, XL-12	operator	₹2.5 lakh is yours; range is our judgement (Paytm average ₹2.05 lakh)

Rows shaded amber are our judgement; rows shaded red rest on sources we could not verify. Both are labelled where they are used.

Status rule: operator = your figure; evidence = a company filing or regulator; unverified = a blog or affiliate guide; derived = our arithmetic; judgement = our call. Table: xs_inputs_v2.csv. IV = agent interview, 15 Oct 2026.

A1 / A11 APPENDIX · EVERY ASSUMPTION (2 OF 2)

Every assumption, continued: the loan, card and product inputs, and the online comparison.

INPUT	LOW	MIDDLE	HIGH	PER	SOURCE IDS	STATUS	NOTE
Origination fee, paid by the lender	2%	**2.625%**	3%	of the loan	operator; XL-13, LEV-009, BM-07	operator	1.5 × a DSA's 1.75% (the middle of blog-reported 1–2.5%); range 2% and 1.5 × 2%
Fees taken back (loan closed or bad in 6 months)	5%	**2.5%**	0%	of fees	XL-13, XL-47	unverified	DSA platform blogs
What one loan earns us	₹4,750	**₹6,398**	₹7,500	a loan	derived	derived	Loan size × fee × (1 – taken back)
Loans that go 90+ days bad	3.6%	**5%**	7%	of loans	MAC-03	judgement	CRIF: 3.6% peak for loans over ₹50,000; 5% is ours
Owed when a loan goes bad		**50%**		of the loan	none	judgement	Half the loan
Recovered of what is owed	30%	**32.5%**	35%		XB-07	evidence	Paytm's results: 30–35%
Our fee on what is recovered	5%	**10%**	15%		NABARD tender (no id)	unverified	Paid about 18 months after the loan, so not in the pilot year
Recovery fees, per loan made	₹51	**₹155**	₹349	a loan	derived	derived	An average over all loans; small: about 2% of the origination fee
Proven savers who get a card (once, month 7)	0.5%	**5%**	5%		operator; XL-54	operator	5% is yours and the top of XL-54's 0.5–5% band for FD-secured cards, which is itself assumed
Fee per approved card	₹500	**₹1,250**	₹2,000	a card	BM-08, XL-20	unverified	Affiliate guides for unsecured cards, which need income proof
Fee per FD-secured card (one-way test only)	₹300	**₹750**	₹1,500	a card	XL-54	judgement	Assumed in XL-54; no published payout (TB-35)
Insurance and other products, from month 7	₹8	**₹63**	₹259	a saver a year	XO-39, XO-10	judgement	Proven savers only; take-ups are ours; PhonePe earns ₹8 a user on insurance
Discount rate		**20%**		a year	inputs.csv	judgement	Applied monthly
Online cost to win a saver	₹186	**₹499**	₹1,340	a saver	TB-18..22, NG-043	judgement	App signals × 1.1 for shopkeepers: no firm publishes it
Online: still saving after a year		**24.2 of 100**			story_unit.csv	derived	Our evidence curve

Rows shaded amber are our judgement; rows shaded red rest on sources we could not verify. Both are labelled where they are used.

Status rule: operator = your figure; evidence = a company filing or regulator; unverified = a blog or affiliate guide; derived = our arithmetic; judgement = our call. Table: xs_inputs_v2.csv.

A2 / A11 APPENDIX · THE LOAN FUNNEL

The loan funnel, step by step: 20% apply × 50% eligible × 35% approved = 3.5 loans per 100 proven savers a year, each earning ₹6,398.

STEP	LOW / MIDDLE / HIGH	EVIDENCE	WHY THE MIDDLE
Proven savers who apply in a year	10% / 20% / 35%	Kissht: 17.5% of registered users ever borrowed (XL-42); Brazil payroll loans: 20% of eligible workers borrowed in year one (LS-06); Paytm: under 1% of monthly users take a financial product in a quarter (XL-04)	Between an app's lifetime figure and a payroll scheme's first year. Judgement.
Applicants who can carry a ₹2.5 lakh EMI	30% / 50% / 70%	Repayments are capped at 50% of income for households up to ₹3 lakh a year (XL-34); His customers earn ₹20,000–40,000 a month (IV-04); 41% of small-business borrowers already have an active loan (XB-09)	About half clear the income bar for that EMI. Judgement.
Eligible applicants a lender approves	25% / 35% / 50%	One lender gave the founder 25% (founder's data); Kissht approves 11% of new applicants and 74% of repeat ones (XL-41)	Several lenders, and months of saving as a repeat-like record, can lift one lender's 25%. Judgement, untested.
= Loans per 100 proven savers a year	0.75 / 3.5 / 12.25	apply × eligible × approved	Derived.
Loan size	₹1,00,000 / ₹2,50,000 / ₹3,00,000	Paytm's average merchant loan: ₹2.05 lakh (XB-08); Bachatt's partners lend up to ₹5 lakh (XL-12)	₹2.5 lakh is yours; the range is our judgement.
Origination fee, paid by the lender	2% / 2.625% / 3%	1.5 × a DSA's 1.75% on personal loans (XL-13, a DSA platform blog); benchmarks on A3	The lender pays our fee; the borrower pays us nothing (XL-01).
Fees taken back	5% / 2.5% / 0%	DSA fees can be taken back if a loan closes or goes bad within 6 months (XL-47)	Unverified: DSA platform blogs.
= What one loan earns us	₹4,750 / ₹6,398 / ₹7,500	loan size × fee × (1 – taken back)	Derived.
Recovery fees, per loan made	₹51 / ₹155 / ₹349	CRIF: loans over ₹50,000 peak at 3.6% going 90+ days bad (MAC-03); 50% still owed (judgement); Paytm-sourced loans: 30–35% recovered after 90+ days (XB-07); our fee 5%–15% of what is recovered (unverified)	An average over all loans, paid about 18 months later, so not in the pilot year's cash.

With several lenders we must show every matching offer and push none (XL-46). RBI draft: rate ceilings on loans up to ₹50,000 from April 2027 (REG-078): our ₹2.5 lakh loans sit above that line.

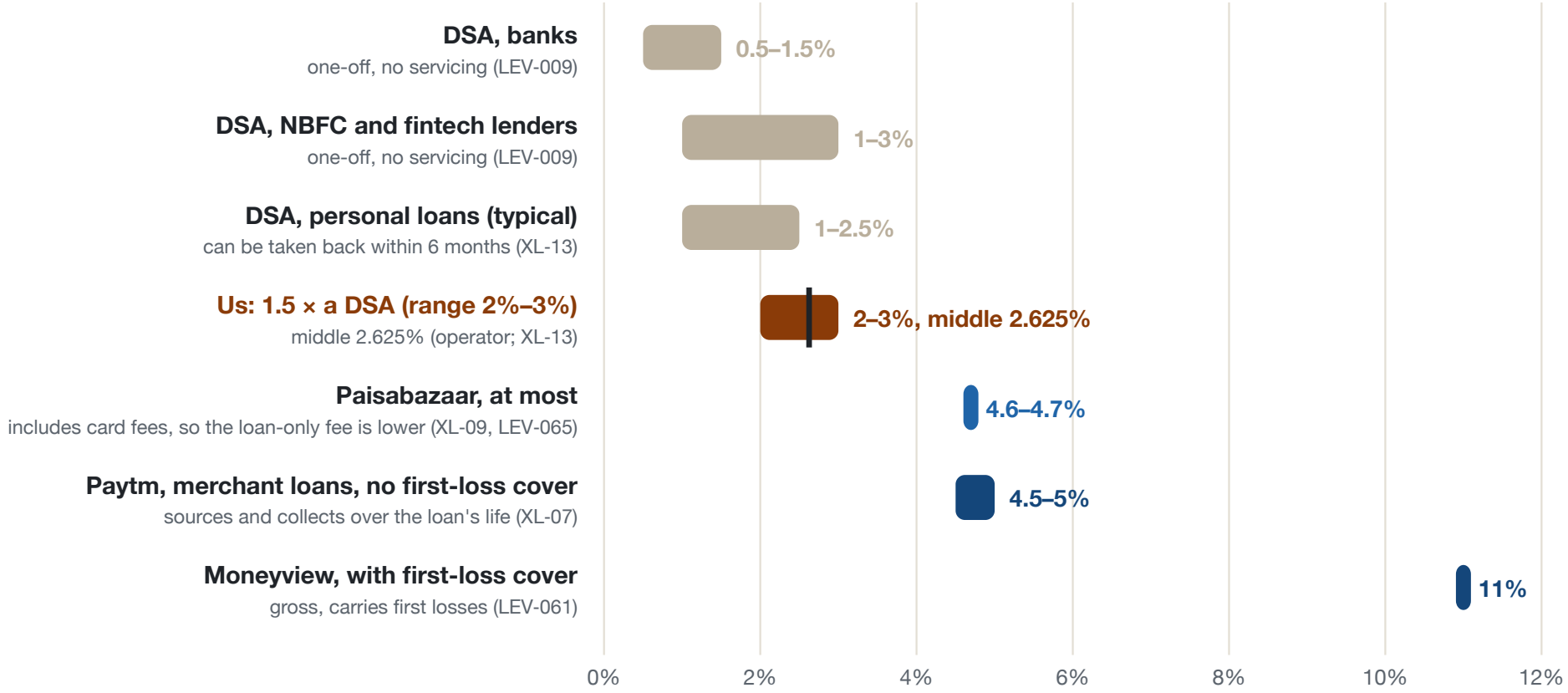
All three funnel rates are our judgement and untested; they are what the pilot's months 7–12 must measure.

Tables: xs_inputs_v2.csv, xs_evidence_v2.csv; research/xs_lending.csv, market_benchmarks.csv; interview (IV-04).

A3 / A11 APPENDIX · ORIGINATION FEE BENCHMARKS

Why 2.625% is defensible: it is inside the DSA band and below Paisabazaar's ceiling; full-service models earn more because they collect or carry losses.

WHAT A LOAN EARNS THE ONE WHO SOURCES IT, % OF THE LOAN



We would be a referral marketplace with no first-loss cover, so the DSA band is our comparison, not Paytm's or Moneyview's fee.

Table: xs_benchmarks_v2.csv (LEV-009, XL-13, XL-09, LEV-065, XL-07, LEV-061, each checked against research/*.csv). DSA rates come from platform blogs: unverified.

Credit cards: 5 in 100 proven savers at ₹1,250 is ₹6,250 once per 100, not a yearly amount; the share is yours, the fee unverified.

CARD MONEY, 100 PROVEN SAVERS

100 proven savers
saved 6+ months, still saving

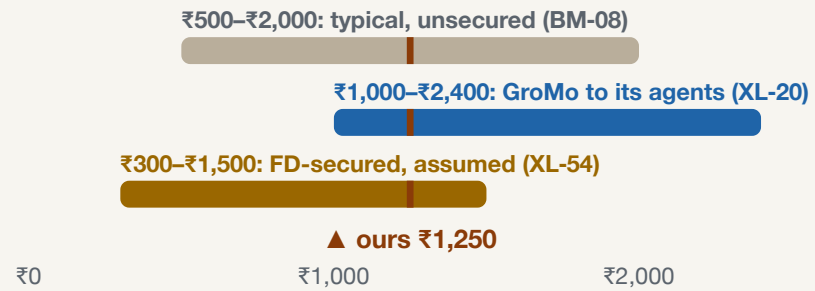
5 get a card
once, in month 7 (your 5%)

× ₹1,250 a card (unverified)

= ₹6,250 once, not every year

one agent, steady book: ₹46,351 a year at 55 of 100

FEE PER APPROVED CARD



Per customer won, 5 years: ₹42 at 55 of 100, 9% of his value

WHO CAN GET ONE, AND THE RULES

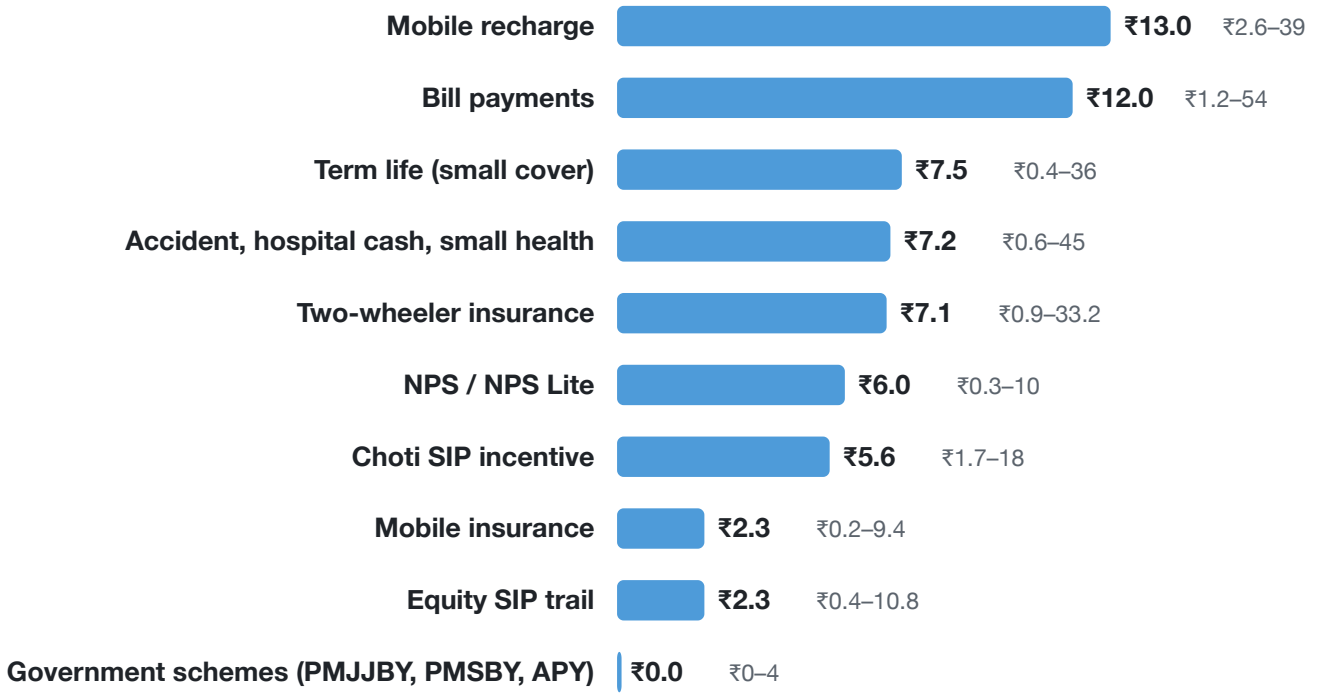
- ✕ **Unsecured cards need salaried or ITR income and a** bureau score (XL-20)
- ✕ **An FD-secured card needs an FD at the issuing bank;** our fund is not one (REG-029, XL-54, TB-35)
- ! **No published payout for FD-secured cards, and no** count of them (TB-35, BM-08)
- ! **The issuer decides who gets a card; we may only** source it (REG-087)
- ! **No first-loss cover is allowed on credit cards** (REG-007)
- ! **Only 3% of Indians hold a credit card; new cards** fell 28% in a year (XL-40)
- ✓ **Paisabazaar issued 91,000 cards in one quarter** (Apr–Jun 2026) (XL-08)

The fee we can see is for unsecured cards, which need income proof; the card that fits our saver, FD-secured, has no published fee.

Tables: xs_money_v2.csv, xs_years_v2.csv, xs_inputs_v2.csv, xs_evidence_v2.csv: BM-08, REG-007, REG-029, REG-087, TB-35, XL-08, XL-20, XL-40, XL-54.

Insurance and other products, product by product: ₹63 a proven saver a year from month 7; a draft IRDAI rule can cut the insurance lines, ₹24.1 of it.

RUPEES A PROVEN SAVER A YEAR, FROM MONTH 7, MIDDLE CASE (LOW–HIGH ALONGSIDE)



Total (FD excluded) **₹63.0** low ₹8.3, high ₹259.4

Matches the model's ₹63 (₹8 / ₹259); the low and high differ only by rounding.

CROSS-CHECK

Our four insurance lines add up to ₹24.1 a saver a year: 3.0× PhonePe's ₹8 a user (XO-10).

Savers buy more than the average UPI user, so 2–3× PhonePe is defensible; 9× is not (XO-38).

RISK: IRDAI COMMISSION CAPS

IRDAI draft caps: comments close 25 Oct 2026; not yet law (REG-053)

Health and accident, first sale: 15%; health renewals: 5% (REG-054, XO-19)

Third-party motor: nil to 2.5% (XO-18)

Term life: 7.5–25% in the first year (XO-20)

A distributor licence (IDE) needs ₹10 lakh of capital (REG-057)

No single product is big; the take-up rates are our judgement. FD referrals are left out because the fund line already counts his balance.

Table: xs_other_build_v2.csv (from research/xs_other_summary.md, XO-01 to XO-39); xs_evidence_v2.csv (XO-10, XO-38, REG-053, REG-054, XO-18 to XO-20, REG-057).

Year by year for one agent: year 1 loses; by year 5 at 55 of 100 he needs 39% of his book on UPI to stay within 400 visits a day.

One agent at 55 of 100 still saving after a year, salary only (money in each year, not discounted, except the discounted result). * Year 1 includes ₹540 of recovery fees, paid later; page 14 leaves them out.

	SAVERS AT YEAR END	PROVEN SAVERS	LOANS	CARDS	FUND	LOAN FEES	CARD FEES	INSURANCE AND MORE	RECOVERIES	INCOME	SALARY	RESULT	RESULT, DISCOUNTED	VISITS A DAY NEEDED	SHARE ON UPI NEEDED
Year 1*	772	329	3.5	18.5	₹41,986	₹22,351	₹23,176	₹6,288	₹540	**₹94,341**	₹2,40,000	**–₹1,45,659**	–₹1,36,142	309	0%
Year 2	1,196	753	20.3	37.1	₹1,25,364	₹1,29,736	₹46,351	₹36,497	₹3,133	**₹3,41,082**	₹2,40,000	**₹1,01,082**	₹74,341	478	16%
Year 3	1,429	986	31.2	37.1	₹1,71,221	₹1,99,507	₹46,351	₹56,125	₹4,818	**₹4,78,023**	₹2,40,000	**₹2,38,023**	₹1,49,004	572	30%
Year 4	1,558	1,115	37.2	37.1	₹1,96,443	₹2,37,881	₹46,351	₹66,920	₹5,745	**₹5,53,341**	₹2,40,000	**₹3,13,341**	₹1,64,069	623	36%
Year 5	1,628	1,185	40.5	37.1	₹2,10,315	₹2,58,987	₹46,351	₹72,858	₹6,255	**₹5,94,766**	₹2,40,000	**₹3,54,766**	₹1,55,011	651	39%

Each year's result at each retention, and the NPV

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3	YEAR 4	YEAR 5	5-YEAR NPV	3-YEAR NPV
30 of 100 still saving	–₹1,70,526	–₹26,239	₹18,288	₹31,645	₹35,653	**–₹1.35 lakh**	–₹1.67 lakh
40 of 100 still saving	–₹1,59,799	₹25,237	₹1,00,595	₹1,30,739	₹1,42,796	**+₹0.63 lakh**	–₹0.68 lakh
55 of 100 still saving	–₹1,45,659	₹1,01,082	₹2,38,023	₹3,13,341	₹3,54,766	**+₹4.06 lakh**	+₹0.87 lakh
70 of 100 still saving	–₹1,33,064	₹1,76,618	₹3,94,223	₹5,46,546	₹6,53,173	**+₹8.23 lakh**	+₹2.52 lakh

Savers at year end · cash visits a day if none use UPI · share that must save by UPI to stay within 400 visits a day

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3	YEAR 4	YEAR 5
30 of 100 still saving	611 · 244 · 0%	794 · 318 · 0%	849 · 340 · 0%	866 · 346 · 0%	871 · 348 · 0%
40 of 100 still saving	680 · 272 · 0%	952 · 381 · 0%	1,061 · 424 · 6%	1,105 · 442 · 9%	1,122 · 449 · 11%
55 of 100 still saving	772 · 309 · 0%	1,196 · 478 · 16%	1,429 · 572 · 30%	1,558 · 623 · 36%	1,628 · 651 · 39%
70 of 100 still saving	854 · 341 · 0%	1,451 · 580 · 31%	1,870 · 748 · 47%	2,162 · 865 · 54%	2,367 · 947 · 58%

The pilot year is year 1: –₹1,46,199 at 55 of 100 in cash, without recovery fees. Loans, cards and insurance start in month 7.

Base case and sources: A1. Tables: xs_years_v2.csv, xs_npv_v2.csv.

A7 / A11 APPENDIX · PAYTM IN DETAIL

Paytm against an app and our street agent, line by line, on this deck's numbers.

	An app	Paytm: the closest to us	Our street agent
How he is won	ads, installs, sign-up offers	a field force at the shop	**an agent at the counter**
Cost to win him	₹499	up to ~₹5,000 per device added (an upper bound; includes servicing)	**₹240**
What keeps him	push notifications	a box on the counter: device shops held through the 2024 shock (1.06 → 1.07 crore)	**the visit every 2–3 days**
What he earns them every year	the same products, if he stays	₹1,080 in device rent (₹90 a month), before loan fees	**₹439 all-in per proven saver (fund, loans, recoveries, insurance and more), plus ₹62 once for a card**
What one loan earns	a referral fee	₹9,225–₹10,250 (4.5%–5% of ₹2,05,000), before first-loss cover	**₹6,398 (2.625% of ₹2.5 lakh, less 2.5% taken back)**
How it collects	the borrower's bank account	from the shop's daily payout: losses 4.5–5%	**the lender collects; we earn a fee if a bad loan is recovered**

✓ **Our edge:** we win him for ₹240, not up to ₹5,000: about 20× less (20.8× against the upper bound).

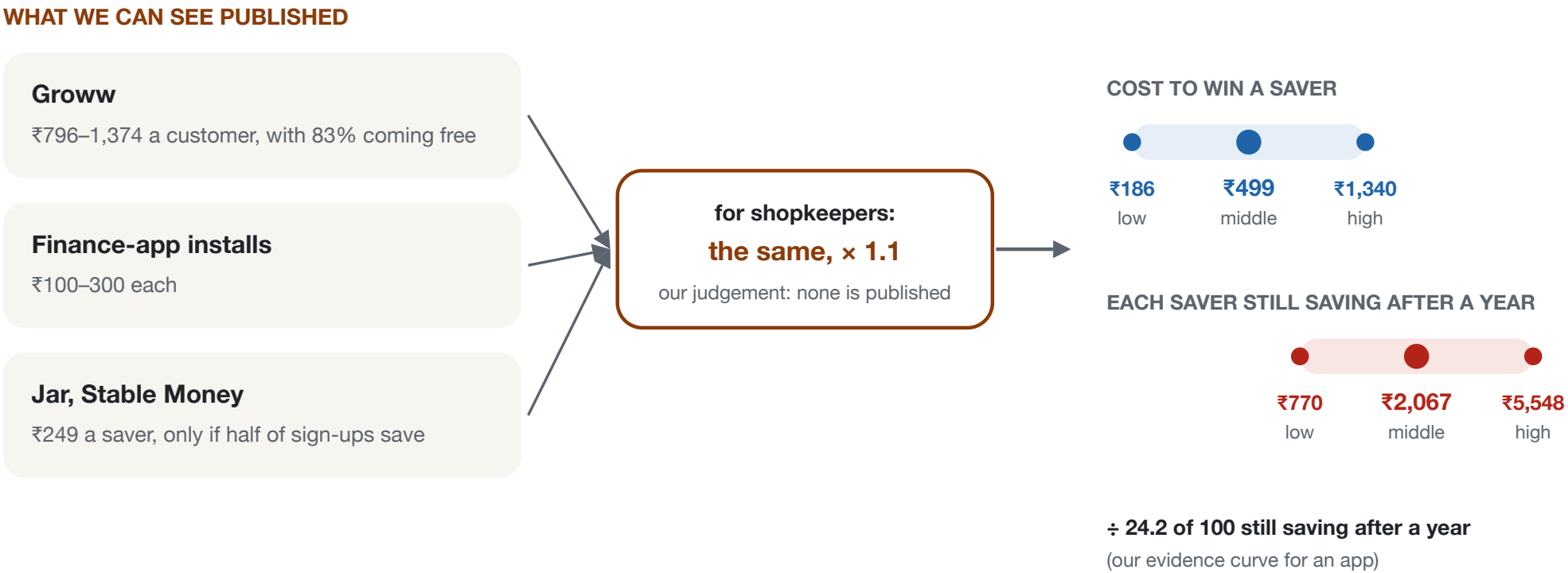
× **Our gap:** Paytm's rent alone is 2.5× our all-in income per proven saver a year, and each Paytm loan earns 1.4–1.6× ours, because it collects over the loan's life.

Our edge is the cheap win and the visit. Our gap is what each customer pays us.

Tables: story_paytm.csv (QM-06..22, XL-07, XB-08), xs_paytm_v2.csv.

A8 / A11 APPENDIX · THE ONLINE COST TO WIN

How we estimate the online cost to win: three published signals, scaled up 10% for shopkeepers, give ₹186 / ₹499 / ₹1,340 a saver.



Divided by 24.2 of 100 still saving after a year, each saver kept costs ₹770–₹5,548. The × 1.1 is our judgement.

Tables: distributions.csv (online cost to win: TB-18..TB-22, TB-37, TB-38, BM-04, BM-05, NG-043), story_unit.csv.

A9 / A11 APPENDIX · THE ONE INTERVIEW

The one interview behind the best case, and where our plan asks far more of an agent than his job does today.

QUESTION	ONE JANTA AGENT'S ANSWER (15 OCT 2026)	WHAT THIS DECK ASSUMES
Book size	200 to 400 customers	1,628 savers by year 5 at 55 of 100; 400 cash visits a day reach 1,000
Customer types	Shopkeepers (most), street vendors, homemakers, daily-wage workers, drivers, salaried, small workshop owners	
Daily deposit	₹200 to 500	₹350 a day, 20 days a month (our judgement)
Monthly income of a typical customer	₹20,000 to 40,000	
Have a smartphone (of 10)	9 or 10	
Have UPI (of 10)	9 or 10	
Of every ₹100 collected, in cash	90 or more	
Why cash despite UPI	Habit	
What customers asked about last month	A loan, insurance	loans, cards and insurance from month 7
What customers need most	A loan	loans, cards and insurance from month 7
How long most customers have saved with him	Over 5 years	30–70 of 100 still saving after a year
New customers last month / closed last month	6 to 10 / 6 to 10	83 new savers a month
Pay	Fixed salary ₹15,000-25,000; under 2% on collections	₹20,000 a month, no cut of collections; ₹15,000–₹25,000 tested
Operator's note after the call	Bank employees. They collect cash and have trust	

> **He is a co-operative bank employee of 10+ years with a mature book, so his 72 of 100 may flatter what fresh sign-ups do.**

Agent interview, 15 Oct 2026 (IV-01 to IV-14; the agent's identity, IV-15, is withheld). Tables: xs_years_v2.csv, pilot_rules_v2.csv.

A10 / A11 APPENDIX · WHAT IS LEFT OUT

What is left out: the cost of tele-sales, AI support, the office and licences, and two upsides we have not counted.

Tele-sales and AI support cost not counted
Missed-debit follow-ups, the move to UPI, loan pre-checks. Not in any number here.

Office, managers, training cost not counted
One agent's salary is the only cost counted.

Licences cost not counted
A distributor licence (IDE) needs ₹10 lakh of capital (REG-057); A corporate agent selling only insurance needs ₹50 lakh net worth (REG-059); a mutual-fund distributor code; lender agreements.

KYC, cash handling, agent churn cost not counted
Full output from month 1 is assumed; a new agent, or one who leaves, earns less.

A Paytm-like fee for collecting on the visit upside not counted
Paytm earns 4.5%–5% a loan (XL-07); it needs first-loss cover, which RBI caps at 5% of loans (SE-04).

Repeat loans and renewals upside not counted
Kissht approves 11% of new applicants and 74% of repeat ones (XL-41); insurance renewals are not counted.

Rules can cut the fees risk
IRDAI draft caps: comments close 25 Oct 2026; not yet law (REG-053); RBI draft: rate ceilings on loans up to ₹50,000 from April 2027 (REG-078).

Copying risk
PhonePe already offers a ₹100-a-day deposit (QM-33). That can hit how many keep saving.

The support costs need modelling before the pilot budget is set; the pilot year cost on page 14 is the agent alone.

Table: xs_evidence_v2.csv (REG-057, REG-059, REG-053, REG-078, XL-41); XL-07, SE-04 (research/story_evidence.csv); QM-33 (research/qr_moat.csv).

A11 / A11 APPENDIX · WHAT CHANGED FROM THE LAST DECK

What changed: tighter balances and later insurance raise the 5-year bar from 28.8 to 36.9 of 100; the last deck's was 33.6.

The 5- and 3-year bars, step by step (still saving after a year, salary only)

STEP	5-YEAR BAR	3-YEAR BAR	5-YEAR NPV AT 55 OF 100
Last deck: 1% fee, 2.5 loans per 100, cards on every sign-up	33.6	42.2	₹2,87,183
Today's fee and funnel, cards still paid on every sign-up	22.3	27.4	₹6,47,589
v2 as first built: cards only to proven savers, once, in month 7	28.8	35.6	₹5,73,030
M1 alone: the balance builds over each yearly term	33.0	41.2	₹4,91,866
M2 alone: insurance and other products from month 7, proven savers only	32.8	41.0	₹4,87,447
M1 + M2 together: this deck	36.9	46.7	₹4,06,283

What else changed

	BEFORE	NOW	EFFECT OR WHY
Origination fee per loan	1% of ₹2.5 lakh: ₹2,438 kept	**2.625% (1.5 × a DSA): ₹6,398 kept**	operator: 1.5 × a DSA
Loans per 100 proven savers a year	2.5 (one lender approves 25%)	**3.5 (a marketplace approves 35%)**	several lenders
Credit cards	5% of sign-ups, ₹1,250, in the month he joins	**5% of proven savers, ₹1,250, once, in month 7**	a card is a lender product
Recovery fees on bad loans	not counted	**₹155 a loan on average**	the marketplace model's middle case
M1: money in his fund	₹42,000 from his first day	**builds ₹7,000 a month; paid out at each term's end; ₹42,000 on average**	5-year bar alone: 28.8 → 33.0
M2: insurance and other products	every saver, from month 1	**proven savers only, from month 7**	5-year bar alone: 28.8 → 32.8
M3: one agent's capacity	not checked	**400 cash visits a day; 39 of 100 on UPI by year 5 at 55 of 100**	no effect on NPV: a condition the pilot must test
M4: recovery fees in the pilot year	counted	**left out: they arrive about 18 months after a loan**	pilot year only
M5: one-way tests	13 rows	**15 rows: salary ₹15,000–25,000, FD-secured card fee ₹300–1,500, card share 0.5–5%**	no effect on the base
0.5% of balance, 5-year break-even	never, at a 1% fee	**69.8 of 100**	new fee, funnel, cards, M1, M2
Pilot year, after what his savers bring in	–₹71,239 to –₹99,569	**–₹1,33,693 to –₹1,70,896**	first v2 build: –₹84,812 to –₹1,25,223
Stop lines at months 3 / 6	76 / 58 of 100	**78 / 61 of 100**	follow the new month-12 bar (rounded up)
Paytm earns more per loan	3.7–4.1×	**1.4–1.6×**	against ₹6,398 kept

Each change is shown alone (amber rows) and then together; M3, M4 and M5 do not move the bar.

Tables: xs_fix_effects_v2.csv, xs_changes_v2.csv (built from npv_takes.csv, pilot_rules.csv, story_paytm.csv, mkt_fee_sensitivity.csv and this model).